

her, saying she was sorry their trip was being cut short. She sent a message to her mother and got ready to go home. Philip was just as shocked, wondering what the future now held for him.

When asked what name she would use as queen, she answered, “My own name, Elizabeth, of course.” Then came a short flight to Uganda’s Entebbe airport, a delay caused by a thunderstorm, and a long flight to London. There were many hours to sit and think, before her plane landed on the evening of February 7. Churchill stood with government members, waiting. “Shall I go down alone?” she asked. In a black coat and hat, she stepped onto UK soil as the country’s new sovereign.

The next day, she was formally proclaimed queen, promising to do her duty as her father had done.



Dressed in black in mourning for her father, Elizabeth left the plane to meet her government.